

Strategic Environment Mapping

Why this matters

For the LST, Board, and investors, it is valuable to maintain an up to date view of the ecosystem around Yousician.

The goal is to better understand who is operating in and around our space, where the industry is heading, which companies are growing, what strategic moves are happening, how AI is affecting the landscape, and what this might mean for Yousician over time.

This should become a living document that can be updated regularly and used as input for strategic discussions.

The task

Create a map of the ecosystem around Yousician.

Think broadly. The goal is not simply to identify competitors, but to understand the strategic environment in which music learning exists.

Potential categories include, but don't be limited by this:

Music learning apps and platforms

Direct and indirect competitors, from large players to emerging startups.

Examples: Simply, Fender Play, Ultimate Guitar, Flowkey, Skoove, Artie Piano, Justin Guitar, etc.

Instrument brands, manufacturers and distributors

Examples: Fender, Yamaha, Roland, Gibson, Thomann, Guitar Center, Sweetwater, etc.

Teachers, schools and music education organizations, teacher of teachers

Music hobby software ecosystem

Examples: BandLab, MuseScore, Songsterr, Splice, GarageBand, Ableton, Soundtrap, etc.

Wider education and self improvement ecosystem

Examples: Duolingo, Kahoot, Knowunity, Chegg, Brilliant, MasterClass, Babbel, etc.

Investors active in the space

VCs, growth funds, strategic investors and other capital allocators with an interest in music, education, creator tools, subscriptions, consumer apps, AI, or gaming.

Influencers, creators and educators

Examples: Marty Schwartz, Justin Guitar, Rousseau, major YouTube channels, TikTok creators, educators and communities.

Media, publishers and cultural drivers

Examples: music magazines, journalists, bloggers, parent and family bloggers, kids education media, major music related TV shows, movies, artists, and cultural phenomena that drive interest in music.

AI companies and AI initiatives

Companies using AI to transform learning, coaching, content creation, personalization, music generation, engagement, discovery, or productivity.

Awards

Who is awarding education, music products that we could benefit from

Funding

Any explicit funding sources e.g. public funding for the type of services we may want offer

Last 24 months on the market

Who made the news for what. Funding rounds, M&As, other things that we should be aware of

Scope

We already have a separate initiative focused on detailed competitor product analysis from a user perspective.

This project does not need deep product reviews of competitors. Focus instead on:

- Who they are
- How large they are

- What they are known for
- How they are evolving
- How they use AI
- Why they matter in the ecosystem

For app based companies, Appfigures should be used where possible to estimate revenue, growth, rankings, and historical performance.

Suggested output

Ecosystem map

A visual overview of the major stakeholder groups and how they relate to Yousician.

Key players

Identify the most strategically relevant organizations and individuals in each category.

For these, provide:

- Short description
- Estimated size and reach
- Ownership / investors (where relevant)
- AI related initiatives (where relevant)
- Why they matter

Database

Maintain a broader table of additional companies and individuals, including relevant information

Relationships

Leave space to capture existing Yousician relationships with companies or individuals. I can help fill these in later.

Guiding question

The objective is to answer:

- Who influences the future of music learning? Who is successful?
- Who influences the future of music as a hobby?
- Who influences the future strategic environment around Yousician?